

UREL-2303

Completing Sentences

The task of completing sentences aims at developing the intelligence of the students as well as revising the grammatical structures. When a student is asked to complete a sentence or to fill up a gap he is required to have two things; enough intelligence to find out a word which may have a meaning suitable to the context and knowledge of the suitable form of that word. However regular exercise and revision of grammatical knowledge will enable him/her to do the task successfully. It is strongly suggested that before trying to fill up the gap a student should try to understand the meaning of the given words and try to imagine a suitable meaning.

Filling up the gaps may be based on following aspects.

- Grammatical structure
- Use of conjunction
- Use of preposition
- Appropriate adjective for a given noun
- Appropriate adverb
- Participle and gerund
- Some well-known phrases.

Some structures are given below for revision. The words in italics may be chosen for gaps.

1. Too-to : The old man is *too weak* to walk. (The old man is very weak and so can not walk.)
The load is *too heavy* for me to carry.
It is *too* interesting a matter for us *to* overlook.
2. so----that: The man was *so ill* that he *could not* move an inch. (The old man is very ill and he could not move.)
3. so that/ in order that : We eat food *so that* we can get strength.
I closed the door of house *so that/in order that* he could not enter my house.
4. Provided/provided that/providing that: We shall start our journey tomorrow *provided/ provided that/providing that* it does not rain.
5. Cannot but/ cannot help: You *cannot but* do the work.
You *cannot help* doing the work.
6. Lest: He ran away lest he might/should be seen.
The officer was sympathetic to the peon *lest* he *should* go away.
7. Would rather : I *would rather* die *than* beg. (dying is preferable to begging to me).
8. Had better : You *had better* leave the place. (It is advisable for you to leave the place.)
9. No sooner had...Than...: No sooner *had* he seen the police *than* he left the place. (As soon as he saw the police he left the place)
10. It is time/It is high time: *It is high time* we left the place.
11. As if/as though : He told the matter *as if /as though* he had known it.
She proceeds *as though* I did not speak.
12. Let alone: He can not pass in the third division, *let alone* in the first division. (It is beyond imagination that he will pass in the first division when he doesn't have any ability to pass in the third division.)
13. Relative pronoun: I saw the man *who* was catching the fish.

- This is the house *that* he wants to buy.
 The writer took a cabin, *which* belonged to the orphanage.
 The boy *whom* you met yesterday is my brother.
 The old man *whose* son died in the road accident has come here.
14. Conditional sentences: *If* he wants, I *shall* help him.
 Doctor Reed *visits* some patients in the morning, *if gets* enough time.
Be sincere, *if* you want to make you future bright.
If he *came*, I *would* go.
If I *had seen* him, I *might have told* him the news.
If they *had started* earlier, they *could have got* the train.
If I *were* a king, I *could help* you.
Had I seen him, I *would have helped* him.
15. The place where: Rangpur is the place *where* Tareq was born.
16. The time when: 1971 is the year *when* Bangladesh became independent.
17. So much/so many that: You have *so much* money that you can buy anything you like.
18. In case: He will carry an umbrella *in case* it rains.
19. Would that/I wish: *Would that* he *were* alive today.
20. To be: I know him *to be* honest.
 He wants the job *to be* done sincerely.
 He was judged *to be* guilty.
21. As : People condemn Mirjafar *as* treacherous.
 I can't accept him *as* my wisher.
- 21: Take—for: I took him *for* my friend.
22. Would you mind : Would you mind *taking* a cup of tea?
23. Conjunctions like unless, until, till, as long as, though, although, since, because, : *Unless* you start at once, you will miss the train.
 Wait *until* the train stops.
 Rajib's mother will be nursing him *till* he comes round.
 Wait here *as long as* it rains.
Though he is poor, he is large hearted.
Since body and mind go together, illness of one inevitably affects the other.
24. Preposition like, in spite of, despite, instead of, in lieu of, because of, on account of, owing to, due to etc.: *In spite* of his poverty he is honest.
Despite his good qualifications, he did not get a suitable job.
Instead of history he took logic.
 He ate fish *in lieu* of meat.
 Everybody loves him *because of* his honesty.
On account of his illness he could not attend the meeting.
25. Participle: I saw them *playing* cricket.
Standing on the beach he enjoyed the sunset.
 A *rolling* stone gathers no moss.
26. Gerund: By *working* hard he earned a lot of money.
Smoking is detestable to me.
 I hate *smoking*.
 My grand father uses a *looking* glass while reading newspaper.

Exercise:

1. The boy is ---- small to touch the roof.
2. I saw them-----cricket.
3. He ran fast-----he should miss the train.
4. Dinajpur is a place-----a lot of rice grows.
5. I wish I ---a bird.
6. You cannot----doing the work.
7. ---you mind opening the door?
8. The boy is sharp---to understand the matter.
9. They will play--- the weather is good.
10. Wait---- I come back.
11. ---illness, he attended the meeting.
12. It is -----time you started the work.
13. Industry is the -----to success.
14. He cannot walk a mile---ten miles.
15. -----there is will, there is way.
16. You-----better leave the place.
17. He asked ----I was doing.
18. You can go ----your work is done.
19. A tree is known by its-----
20. Hurry up-----you will be late.
21. We want that the books-----collected at once.
22. The character of such a man is ---- suspicious.
23. The stranger enquired -----I lived.
24. He would -----starve than steal.
25. The man cannot read Bengali-----English.
26. You will not pass in the examination--- you work hard.
27. Birds cannot fly----they?
28. -----will suffer in the long run.
29. -----on a chair, he began to speak.
30. He would ----fail than copy.
31. In spite of his -----, he is unhappy.
32. ----I use your pen?
33. No sooner ---I gone out than he came.
34. You ----better leave the place.
35. If they wanted, we ---help them.
36. 1971 is the year--- Bangladesh became independent.
37. He shed ----tears.
38. ----eating vegetables, we cannot get vitamins.
39. A---stone gathers no moss.
40. I have not seen him----last week.
41. He looks as if he---a wise man.
42. Would that I ---child again.
43. He----wrote nor phone.
44. Wait for me ---I come back.
45. The boy can not ---going there.
46. -----will suffer in the long run.
47. He would ----fail than copy.
48. In spite of his ---he is unhappy.
49. ----I use your pen?
50. He----with friends came here.
51. He has no passion ----politics.
52. Our prophet (sm) was----by his uncle and grandfather.
53. A stitch in time saves-----
54. Scarcely had he reached the station--- the train left.
55. Choose only such friends ---- you can trust.
56. The father took his son to ----for telling lies.
57. Each boy and each girl ---given a prize.
58. We found her ---in a tank.
59. I have no pen to write ----
60. It is high ----you accepted this job.
61. He worked hard in order that he-----shine in life.
62. Hardly had I come in -----the telephone rang.
63. Man dies ----soul does not.
64. He worked hard--- he might succeed.
65. You can go --- your work is done.
66. I was shocked ----the news of her death.
67. ----of the pictures is yours?
68. Moulana Bhashani is considered to -----great leader.
69. Ten miles---- too far to walk.
70. A stitch in time ----nine.
71. The plane will take off-----the weather is good.
72. The woman as well as her daughters ---well.
73. He lectured--- population problem.
74. He came --- I had gone out.
75. Kamal is my friend-----brother lives in Japan.
76. He tells the matter -----he knew it.
77. If I had a typewriter, I ----type the letter.
78. United we stand, divided we----
79. He came at the eleventh----
80. The boy is of no-----
81. To eradicate poverty is a mammoth---
82. They will play-----there is no rain.
83. He is -----for nothing.
84. I found the letter----
85. The boy is ---weak to walk.
86. He finished first -----he began last.

87. The-----,the merrier.
88. Ruman longs ----his father's arrival.
89. If you ---worked hard, you would have succeeded.
90. He is considered to ----a great leader.
91. Hurry up ---you will be late.
92. She is ----poet and a singer.
93. They found the house-----.
94. The leader wants the notice -----.
95. He is known ----an honest man.
96. She will be nursing him---he comes round.
97. He worked ---the sunset.
98. We suppose him ----a great man.
99. It is----we left the place.
100. He behaves ---he were a fool.
101. Make hay ---the sun shines.
102. I had finished the work-----you came.
103. -----he is honest is known to all.
104. A ----man catches at a straw.
105. I would rather die ----tell a lie.
106. He is not so eager ---you are.
107. This is the house-----I bought last year.
108. -----the moon nor the stars were visible in the sky.
109. He is older ---he looks.
110. The bag is ----heavy for me to carry.
111. Try to avoid bribe----you can.
112. -----taking exercise, we can keep our body fit.
113. Not only Aziz -----his brother was present.
114. Electricity is ----in modern age.
115. -----he or his brother has done has done this.
116. -----is key to success.
117. He had a -----headache.
118. I don't like -----fish.
119. He told the story-----he had known it before.
120. Bangladesh is an-----country.
121. The thief was caught -----.
122. If I were a bird, I -----fly.
123. I saw the boy----the tree.
124. Would that he -----alive today.
125. -----the beast in you.
126. It is kind-----you to help us.
127. He is fond----music.
128. Charity -----at homes.
129. The letter is ----Japan.
130. I ----you on your success.
131. The thief ran away ----he should be caught.
132. The sun -----set, we returned home.
133. ----You are the boy----I want.
134. The girl is intelligent-----to understand it.
135. Man is-----
136. -----err is human.
137. What will you do ----you fail?
138. -----his riches, he is not happy.
139. He would rather die---beg.
140. He is strong -----to carry the load.
141. A--- dog seldom bites.
142. -----his merit, he could not pass.
143. This law is-----of date.
144. I want my rice----.
145. As you ----, so you reap.
146. He speaks----he were a wise man.
147. He will carry an umbrella-----it rains.
148. You can go to sleep ----you have taken your meal.
149. It is easy to say but-----to do.
150. I got used to -----up early in the morning.